

Checklist

Mentoring Checklist

Before the mentee starts

- ☐ Clarify the **purpose** of the mentoring relationship.
- ☐ Decide what **success looks like** for the mentee and for the team.
- ☐ Prepare the mentee's **environment** before day one.
- ☐ **Confirm** they will have **access** to tools, systems, software, and workspace.
- ☐ Create or collect the **onboarding docs** they will need.
- ☐ Choose a **project** that is clear, useful, and appropriate to their level.
- ☐ Break the project into **small milestones**.
- ☐ Plan how often you will **check in**.

In the first few days

- ☐ Help the mentee get oriented to the team, office, and workflow.
- ☐ Introduce them to key people and networks.
- ☐ Walk through code, tools, and processes with them.
- ☐ Make it easy for them to ask questions.
- ☐ Check in several times so they do not feel lost or overwhelmed.
- ☐ Explain both formal rules and unspoken norms.

While mentoring

- ☐ Listen carefully before jumping in with answers.
- ☐ Pay attention to what they mean, not just the words they use.
- ☐ Watch for confusion, hesitation, or overload.
- ☐ Repeat or rephrase explanations when needed.
- ☐ Use diagrams, examples, and walkthroughs to improve understanding.
- ☐ Communicate clearly what should happen next.
- ☐ Point them to docs and resources instead of answering everything immediately.
- ☐ Encourage independence without abandoning them.
- ☐ Adjust your support based on their progress and response.
- ☐ Keep the mentee moving in the right direction with small course corrections.

For mentoring an intern

- ☐ Make sure the intern has a real project to work on.
- ☐ Choose something specific but not urgent.
- ☐ Size the project so it can be completed within the internship.
- ☐ Leave room for onboarding, training, and intern program activities.
- ☐ Plan for the intern to present their work at the end.
- ☐ Coach them on how to explain and demo what they built.

For mentoring a new hire

- ☐ Use onboarding documents actively, not passively.
- ☐ Ask the new hire to improve docs when they hit surprises.
- ☐ Help them build relationships across the company.
- ☐ Explain how things really get done, not just how they are documented.

Mentor mindset

- ☐ Stay curious and open-minded.
- ☐ Use the mentee's questions to uncover blind spots in your own understanding.
- ☐ Practice patience, empathy, and clear communication.
- ☐ Treat mentoring as meaningful work, not side work.
- ☐ Be explicit about expectations, time commitment, and boundaries.
- ☐ Say no to mentoring if you cannot do it well.

Avoid these pitfalls

- ☐ Do not intimidate, belittle, or show off.
- ☐ Do not hoard knowledge or use expertise as status.
- ☐ Do not assume the mentee should "just figure it out" alone.
- ☐ Do not let the relationship become vague or unstructured.
- ☐ Do not assign mentoring without matching goals to the right mentor.

At the end

- ☐ Review what the mentee learned and delivered.
- ☐ Reflect on what you learned as a mentor.
- ☐ Note what should be improved in onboarding, docs, or process.
- ☐ Leave the mentee with useful connections and next steps.

